



UK Government

FIRE KILLS CAMPAIGN TOOLKIT

Version 1 – November 2025



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INTRODUCTION

If a fire breaks out in your home, every second is crucial. The earlier you are warned, the greater the chance of making it out safely. But the truth is too many people are still under-protected, relying on too few smoke alarms in too few places.

Fires can start in any room, at any time. Without the right coverage of smoke alarms, you may not hear the warning in time to escape.

The facts are revealing:

- You are around 11 times more likely to die from a fire in the home if you do not have any working smoke alarms.
- Smoke did not reach a smoke alarm in more than a third of fires in the home.
- About 200 people a year die in fires in the home.

The Fire Kills campaign aims to help people understand that installing more smoke alarms in more areas of your home can help make sure you're covered.

www.gov.uk/firekills



CAMPAIGN OVERVIEW

The Fire Kills national campaign relaunched in November 2025 with a new video advert, supported by radio and digital adverts. The campaign reminds people how important it is to have more smoke alarms at home. The creative shows the risks of not having good smoke alarm coverage and the serious consequences that can happen if your home is not properly protected.

Fire risks are relevant to everyone, especially vulnerable audiences. Our wider partnership activity supports everyone, but seeks to focus on those identified as most at risk from fire, including those with physical disabilities or mobility issues, single parents, younger people, smokers and situations where drugs and alcohol are involved.

By working together, we can make sure key fire safety messages reach everyone who needs them and help keep all communities safe. This toolkit gives partners the assets they need in order to share consistent, lifesaving messages to audiences.



YOUR SUPPORT

Thank you for being part of our campaign. Too many people aren't aware of how to fully protect themselves from fire, and that's where your support makes a real difference. By working with us, you can help your audiences ensure they have adequate smoke alarm coverage to give their homes the best possible protection in the case of fire.

As partners, you're not just sharing messages, you're enabling real behaviour change. Together, we can move people from assuming they're protected to taking proactive steps that truly keep them safe.



FIRE KILLS. MAKE SURE YOU'RE SAFE.

Beyond ensuring they have adequate smoke alarm coverage, there are many more actions people can take to either prevent a fire from happening or to make sure they plan for their escape in case fire breaks out. Partners can play an important role in sharing not only detection messaging, but also prevention and escape messaging amongst their audiences.

The **Online Home Fire Safety Check tool** allows you to carry out a thorough check of your home in only a few minutes. You can promote the tool on webpages or in communications to help people ensure their homes are as safe as possible.

Select Language
Powered by Google Translate

Your Progress

Property Location

Assessment Type

Property Ownership

Property Type

Number of Floors

Smoke Alarms

Room Details

Tidiness / Clutter

Heating

Occupants

Health Conditions

Behaviours

Previous Fires

Additional Steps

Once you have completed the initial assessment, additional steps and advice will appear here.

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Are you completing this fire safety check for yourself?

Please tell us whether you are answering these questions about your own home or somebody else's home.

✓

Yes – I am completing this check for my own home

✗

No – I am completing this check for someone else

NEXT STEP

Is your home rented?

In rented homes, the rules are a bit different. Your landlord will have some responsibilities to keep you safe.

✓

Yes - my home is rented

Choose this option if you rent your home from a local authority or private landlord.

✗

No - my home is not rented

Choose this option if you own your home or have a mortgage (including shared ownership schemes).

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[Click here](#) for further fire safety advice for tenants.

NEXT STEP

Online Home Fire Safety Check tool

PREVENTION

Cook safely

Most house fires start in the kitchen. Remind people to stay alert while cooking, especially while using hobs or hot oil. Keep children, pets, and loose clothing away from cookers, never leave pans unattended and always double check appliances are switched off after you’ve finished cooking.

Electrical safety

Faulty or overloaded electrics are a major fire risk. Encourage people to only use one plug per socket and avoid overloading extension leads. Make sure appliances and chargers have proper safety marks and unplug devices when not in use.

Heating

Keep portable heaters clear of curtains, furniture and other fabric and never dry clothes on or close to a portable heater. Check electric blankets for wear and tear to fabric and wiring.

Furniture

Make sure furniture carries a permanent fire-resistant label.

Smoking

Cigarettes are the biggest killer in domestic fires. Remind people to stub cigarettes out fully, never smoke in bed, and to use sturdy ashtrays. Put it out, right out.

Candles

Candles should always be secured in stable, heat-resistant holders, kept away from anything flammable, and extinguished when leaving the room or when you go to bed.

DETECTION

Fit smoke alarms throughout your home

Get more alarms in more places to make sure you're covered. The best position is on ceilings, in the middle of rooms, hallways, and landings so alarms can be heard across the home. Consider fitting smoke alarms in the most used rooms, including bedrooms. Don't fit smoke alarms in or near kitchens or bathrooms where steam may trigger false alarms. If you can't fit alarms yourself, your local fire and rescue service may be able to help.

Test and maintain smoke alarms regularly

Test alarms at least once a month by pressing the button until it sounds. If your alarms have replaceable batteries, change them once a year and only remove them when doing so. If an alarm chirps to signal a low battery, replace it immediately. Clean alarms every six months by vacuuming to remove dust. Always check the expiry date on your alarms and replace them in good time.

Mains-powered alarms are powered by your home electricity supply and have a back-up battery in case of a power cut. They need to be installed by a qualified electrician and, like battery alarms, they do require testing- this tests both the power supply and the smoke detection mechanism. Some battery or mains alarms can be interlinked, so that when one alarm detects a fire they all go off together, giving you warning wherever you are in your home.



ESCAPE

Know your escape routes

Fitting smoke alarms is the first step, but having a clear escape plan could save your life. Encourage people to plan and practise their exit routes and make sure everyone in the home knows them. This is especially important for anyone with physical or mental disabilities or mobility challenges who may need extra time or support to escape safely. The primary route should be the normal way in and out but always identify a second route in case the first one is blocked.

Keep exits clear and accessible

Remind people to keep doors, windows, and escape routes free from obstructions. Door and window keys should be stored where everyone can find them.

If the windows have window restrictors, ensure occupants know how to manually override them. Practising the escape plan regularly helps everyone remember what to do in an emergency.



CAMPAIGN ASSETS

A wide range of materials are available across video, print, social and digital formats. Please share these across your channels, add them to your website, display them across owned media spaces and use them to raise awareness of the campaign.



VIDEO

A 30-second video ad has been created to lead the campaign. It will appear on video-on-demand (VOD) services and across the campaign’s social channels. The film encourages people to use multiple smoke alarms within a home by showing what can happen when there aren’t enough smoke alarms to give proper warning. 15 and 6 second versions of the video ad are also available.

DOWNLOAD HERE



PRINT

A range of downloadable posters are available in different formats. They communicate messages in the detect, prevent and escape messaging pillars and feature an open ‘doll’s house’ visual that explores smoke alarm coverage within a home.

DOWNLOAD HERE



A4 Posters

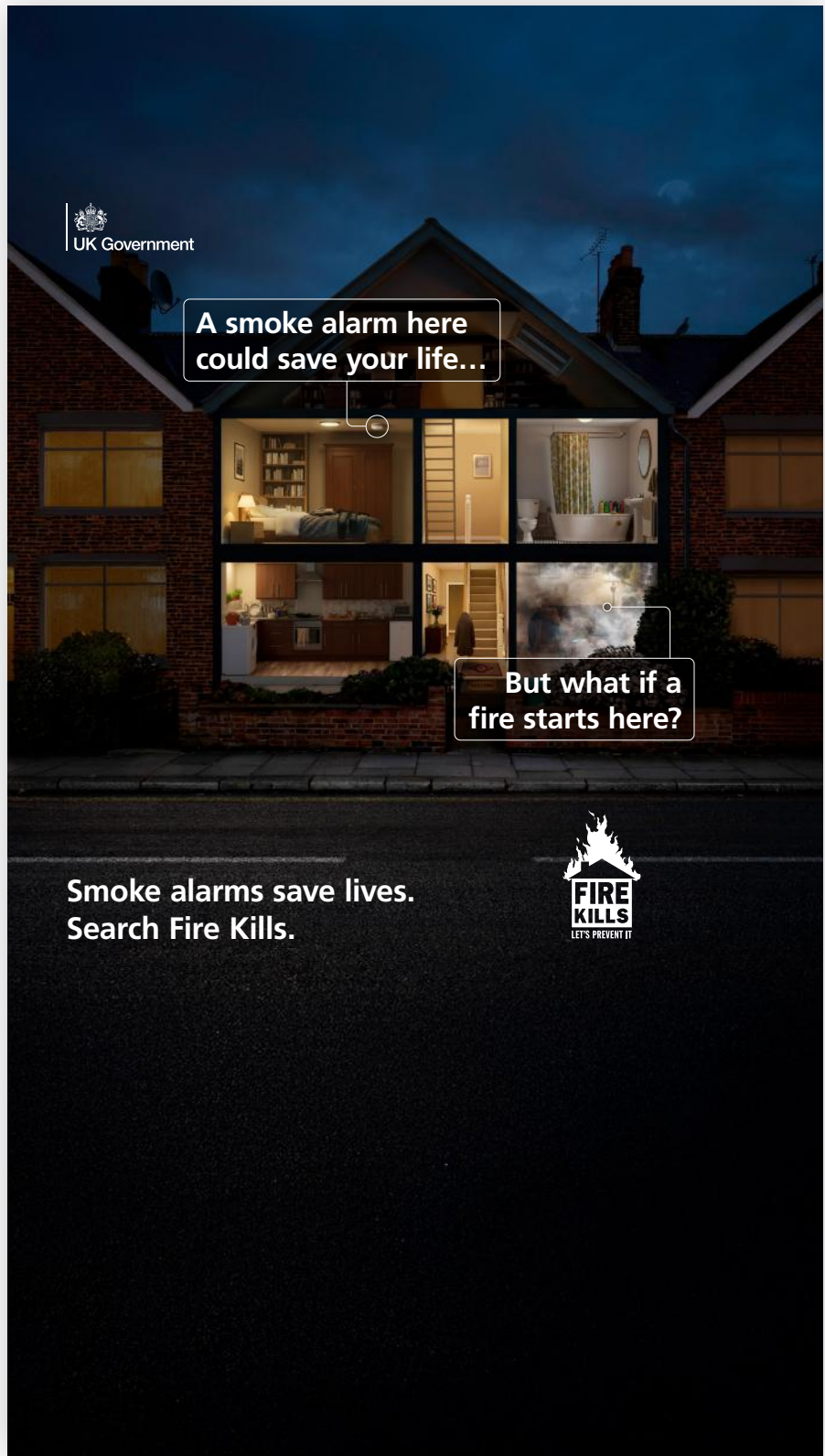


A4 Checklist

SOCIAL

We’ve created a range of social media assets for you to use on your social media channels. Share these resources to communicate the campaigns messages online.

DOWNLOAD HERE



9x16



4x5

1x1



16x9

SOCIAL COPY

Detection (3 options)

Headline: Fire Kills. Get Covered.

Post copy:

- 1)** Working smoke alarms save lives.
Get more alarms in more places to make sure you're covered.
- 2)** Don't wait until it's too late. Fit more smoke alarms in more places in your home to stay protected.
- 3)** In more than a third of fires in the home, smoke didn't reach an alarm in time. Get more alarms in your home.

CTA: Learn more: search Fire Kills.

Prevention

Headline: Fire Kills. Get Safe.

Post copy:

It only takes one mistake for a fire to start. Simple steps like keeping candles away from flammable items and never leaving cooking unattended can keep you safe.

CTA: Learn more: search Fire Kills.

Escape

Headline: Fire Kills. Get Prepared.

Post copy:

When fire starts, you need a clear exit. Keep hallways and doors free from clutter and make sure everyone knows the quickest way out.

CTA: Learn more: search Fire Kills.

THANK YOU

Thank you for being part of the Fire Kills campaign. Your support helps us share vital fire safety messages and keep more people safe in their homes. We'd love to hear how you've used the campaign materials and the impact they've had in your area.

To share your work or to discuss other ways of working together, please get in touch with us at **marketing@communities.gov.uk**

